

Figure 7. Method comparison — backbones evaluated on H&E → DM1

Bold green AUC = UNI Mass-100K final pooled value (Phase 2, N=54, 5-fold mean 0.951 ± 0.081 , $\Delta +0.128$ over ViT-L). CONCH gated on follow-up dispatch.

Architecture	Training corpus	Domain	AUC (Phase 2 TCGA-THCA)	Foundation model?	Status
ResNet50	ImageNet-1k (1.3M nat. images)	Natural images	0.55	No	Closure baseline (2026-05-04)
ViT-L	ImageNet-21k (~14M nat. images)	Natural images	0.746	No	Phase 2 fallback (N=59)
UNI	Mass-100K (100K WSIs, 100M tiles)	H&E pathology	0.874	Yes	FINAL (N=54) 5-fold mean 0.951 ± 0.081
CONCH	Quilt-1M (1.1M image-text pairs)	H&E pathology + text	future	Yes (vision-language)	Future (alternative target, gated)